



INCLUDES

- ✓ Course framework
- ✓ Instructional section
- ✓ Sample exam questions

AP[®] U.S. Government and Politics

COURSE AND EXAM DESCRIPTION

Effective
Fall 2023

NATIONAL CONSTITUTION CENTER



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Sample Exam Questions

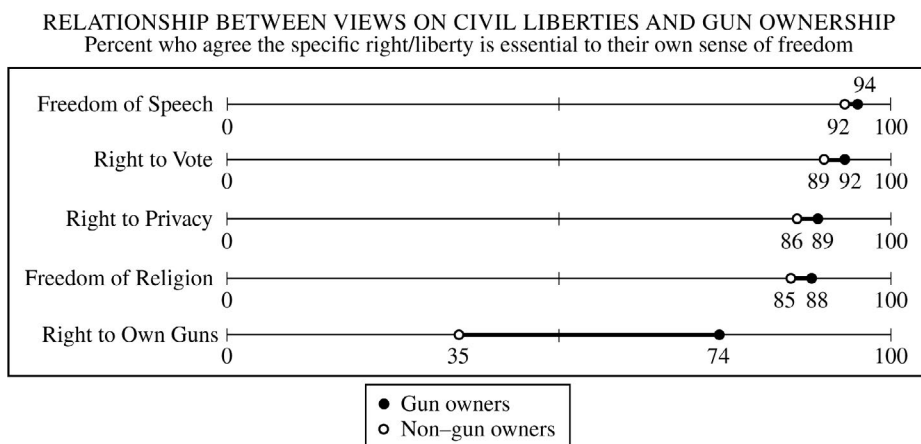
The sample exam questions that follow illustrate the relationship between the course framework and the AP U.S. Government and Politics Exam and serve as examples of the types of questions that appear on the exam. After the sample questions is a table that shows to which skill, learning objective(s), and unit each question relates. The table also provides the answers to the multiple-choice questions.

Section I: Multiple-Choice

1. Despite concerns raised by her constituents, a member of the House of Representatives votes in favor of a bill, believing that in the long term it is in the best interest of her constituents. This is an example of which of the following models of representation?
(A) Delegate
(B) Politico
(C) Trustee
(D) Virtual
2. Which of the following is an accurate comparison of the arguments made in *The Federalist* 10 and *Brutus* 1?

<i>The Federalist</i> 10	<i>Brutus</i> 1
(A) Factions are inevitable with popular sovereignty.	A strong national government is needed.
(B) Factions are most dangerous at the local level.	Small republics are best for stable governments.
(C) Power should be concentrated in the executive branch to address factions.	National government is too far from the people.
(D) The effects of factions cannot be controlled.	Popular sovereignty leads to anarchy.

Questions 3 and 4 refer to the chart.



Source: Survey of United States adults conducted March 13–27 and April 4, 2017, Pew Research Center

3. According to the data, both gun owners and non-gun owners
 - (A) answered similarly regarding the importance of the right to own guns
 - (B) believed that the right to vote was less essential than freedom of religion
 - (C) chose freedom of speech as most essential to their own liberty
 - (D) demonstrated deep division between one another in most categories
4. Which of the following best explains how poll respondents regard the relationship between the right to own guns and personal freedom?
 - (A) The poll shows there is an ongoing debate over whether gun control laws promote or interfere with individual rights.
 - (B) The poll shows that gun owners and non-gun owners have widely different views over a range of civil liberties issues.
 - (C) The poll shows that party polarization has a sizable impact on elections and policymaking at each level of government.
 - (D) The poll shows that even Congress has mixed opinions as to whether the second amendment involves individual liberty.
5. Which of the following powers allows both the federal and state governments to make policies involving taxation?
 - (A) Concurrent powers
 - (B) Exclusive powers
 - (C) Implied powers
 - (D) Enumerated powers
6. In which of the following ways could the president try to limit the impact of a Supreme Court decision?
 - (A) Calling for the removal of the Supreme Court justices
 - (B) Instructing the Department of Justice to delay enforcement of a provision in the decision.
 - (C) Passing legislation that overrides the Court's opinion
 - (D) Changing the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court

Questions 7–9 refer to the excerpt below.

The vice of the groupist theory is that it conceals the most significant aspects of the system. The flaw in the pluralist heaven is that the heavenly chorus sings with a strong upper-class accent. Probably about 90 percent of the people cannot get into the pressure system.

The notion that the pressure system is automatically representative of the whole community is a myth fostered by the universalizing tendency of modern group theories. *Pressure politics is a selective process* ill designed to serve diffuse interests. The system is skewed, loaded, and unbalanced in favor of a fraction of a minority.

—E. E. Schattschneider, *The Semisovereign People*, 1960

7. Which of the following best captures the author's argument regarding the forms of democracy?
 - (A) Pluralist democracy, which seeks to shield elites from popular opinion, functions best when individual citizens do not participate in the process.
 - (B) Participatory democracy, which emphasizes limited participation, marginalizes those who do not have the economic means to participate.
 - (C) Pluralist democracy, though it involves groups at different stages of the process of developing policy, excludes a significant portion of the population.
 - (D) Participatory democracy, which emphasizes expanded participation, creates too much conflict within the system.
8. Which of the following statements about interest groups would the author most likely agree with?
 - (A) Interest groups play the important function of including more people in elections.
 - (B) Interest groups undermine stability by creating too much conflict and polarization in politics.
 - (C) Interest groups tend to over-represent elite interests.
 - (D) Interest groups have less power in American government than political parties have.
9. Which of the following activities would the author most likely be concerned about interest groups engaging in?
 - (A) Educating and mobilizing citizens around their cause
 - (B) Introducing legislation that limits the power of others
 - (C) Representing broad segments of society and sparking emotional political debates
 - (D) Forming iron triangles with bureaucratic agencies and congressional committees

10. According to the United States Constitution, all revenue bills must
- (A) be passed by a conference committee
 - (B) originate in the House of Representatives
 - (C) be passed by two-thirds of the Senate
 - (D) be reviewed by the Supreme Court
11. Which of the following illustrates an economic policy most likely supported by an ideologically liberal individual?
- (A) The Federal Reserve increasing interest rates
 - (B) Congress placing regulations on the marketplace by increasing the minimum wage
 - (C) A bill that would decrease funding for the food stamp program
 - (D) A state lowering income taxes to attract businesses

Questions 12 and 13 refer to the political cartoon.



12. Which of the following is the best interpretation of the political cartoon?
 - (A) Members of Congress are richer than the people they represent.
 - (B) Members of Congress represent a wide diversity of political and economic interests.
 - (C) Members of Congress receive political contributions from many special interest groups.
 - (D) Members of Congress are specialists in economic policy issues.
13. Which of the following Supreme Court cases is most related to the topic in the cartoon?
 - (A) *United States v. Lopez* (1995)
 - (B) *McDonald v. Chicago* (2010)
 - (C) *Shaw v. Reno* (1993)
 - (D) *Citizens United v. Federal Elections Commission* (2010)
14. Which of the following arguments best supports a claim that the Electoral College does not fully support democratic principles?
 - (A) The winner-take-all system encourages candidates to campaign in every state, which limits the attention each state will receive from the candidates.
 - (B) Electors are chosen by the voters in each state, which gives parties undue influence over candidates' success.
 - (C) At times, a candidate who receives the most popular votes may not win the presidential election.
 - (D) The Electoral College lacks transparency because electors frequently switch their vote during the national convention.

15. Which of the following best describes the reasoning in *Baker v. Carr* (1961)?
- (A) Unequal representation of citizens in legislative districts is unconstitutional and may be reviewed by the courts.
 - (B) Political issues such as reapportionment, redistricting, and gerrymandering are to be resolved by the legislative branch.
 - (C) Racial gerrymandering is a violation of the Fourth Amendment's exclusionary clause.
 - (D) Gerrymandering that favors a single party is not subject to legal action because there is no standard to determine how a state legislative district map should be drawn.

Section II: Free-Response

The following are examples of the kinds of free-response questions found on the exam.

Concept Application (Free-Response Question 1 on the AP Exam)

The National Association of Home Builders, a national interest group that represents over 140,000 members in the home construction industry, has endorsed David Valadao (R) for reelection in California's Twenty-First Congressional District in the 2018 midterm election.

"Rep. Valadao has made housing and home ownership a top national priority and understands that expanding housing opportunities for all Americans is essential to the economic and social well-being of our nation," said Randy Noel, chairman of the National Association of Home Builders.

"We are proud to endorse Rep. Valadao for reelection in November because he helped to shepherd the landmark tax reform bill through Congress that will put more money into the pockets of hard-working families, reduce the tax burden for small businesses and promote job and economic growth," Noel said.

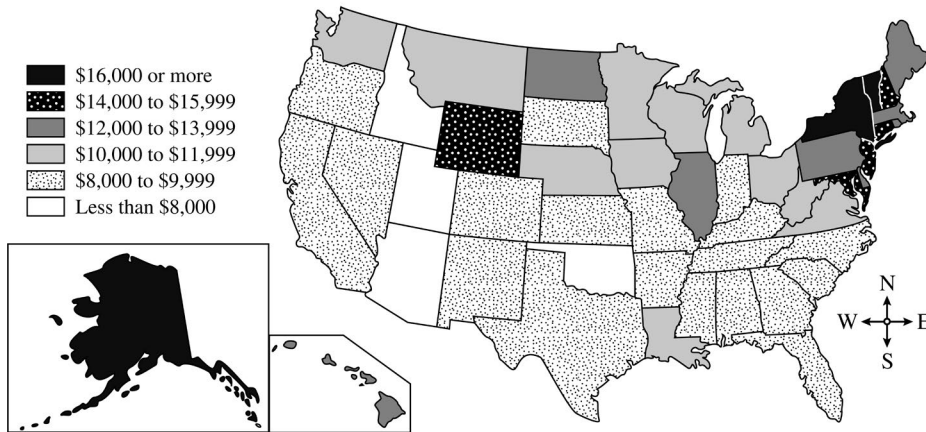
Recent polls show Valadao holding an 11-point lead over Democratic challenger T. J. Cox.

Source: "Valadao Picks Up Several Endorsements," *Hanford Sentinel*
(Hanford, CA), October 19, 2018.

After reading the scenario, respond to A, B, and C below:

- (A) Describe an action being taken by the National Association of Home Builders in the scenario.
- (B) Explain how the action described in Part A affects policymaking in Congress.
- (C) Another group interested in conserving land in California supports the Democratic candidate in the election. Rather than having 140,000 members, the group is led by a few very wealthy families. Explain how this difference will likely affect the conservationist group's strategy in the election.

PUBLIC EDUCATION SPENDING: AMOUNT SPENT PER PUPIL BY STATE IN 2014



Source: FairVote. www.census.gov

Quantitative Analysis (Free-Response Question 2 on the AP Exam)

Use the information graphic to answer the questions.

- (A) Identify the most common level of education spending by states in the Southeast.
- (B) Describe a similarity or difference in public education spending by state or region, as illustrated in the information graphic.
- (C) Draw a conclusion about that similarity or difference in public education spending by state or region illustrated in the information graphic.
- (D) Explain how public education spending as shown in the information graphic demonstrates the principle of federalism.

SCOTUS Comparison (Free-Response Question 3 on the AP Exam)

This question requires you to compare a Supreme Court case you studied in class with one you have not studied in class. A summary of the Supreme Court case you did not study in class is presented below and provides all of the information you need to know about this case to answer the prompts.

In 1935, Congress passed the National Labor Relations Act (NLRA), which among other things guaranteed workers the right to join a labor union and collectively bargain with employers. The law also established the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB), an independent agency responsible for enforcing the law.

The Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation fired ten workers attempting to unionize its plant located in Aliquippa, Pennsylvania. When the National Labor Relations Board determined this to be in violation of the recently passed NLRA, the company sued claiming that labor relations had only an indirect effect on commerce, and thus Congress did not have the constitutional power to regulate it.

In the subsequent case, *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation* (1937), the Supreme Court ruled in favor of the National Labor Relations Board by a 5–4 vote, holding that the Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation conducted interstate commerce and that industrial labor relations affects that commerce.

- (A) Identify the constitutional clause that is common in both *United States v. Lopez* (1995) and *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation* (1937).
- (B) Explain how the facts in *United States v. Lopez* led to a different holding than in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation*.
- (C) Explain how the holding in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation* affected the balance of power between the states and the national government.

Argument Essay (Free-Response Question 4 on the AP Exam)

Develop an argument that explains which of the three models of representative democracy—participatory, pluralist, or elite—best achieves the founders’ intent for American democracy in terms of ensuring a stable government run by the people.

Use at least one piece of evidence from one of the following foundational documents:

- Brutus 1
- Federalist No. 10
- U.S. Constitution

In your response, you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a defensible claim or thesis that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Support your claim with at least TWO pieces of specific and relevant evidence
 - ♦ One piece of evidence must come from one of the foundational documents listed above.
 - ♦ A second piece of evidence can come from any other foundational document not used as your first piece of evidence, or it may be from your knowledge of course concepts
- Use reasoning to explain why your evidence supports your claim or thesis.
- Respond to an opposing or alternate perspective using rebuttal or refutation.

Answer Key and Question Alignment to Course Framework

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Skill	Learning Objective	Unit
1	C	1.E	LO 2.3.A	2
2	B	1.C	LO 1.3.A	1
3	C	3.A	LO 1.3.A	3
4	A	3.C	LO 1.3.A	3
5	A	1.B	LO 1.7.A	1
6	B	1.B	LO 2.11.B	2
7	C	4.A	LO 1.2.A	1
8	C	4.B	LO 5.6.B	5
9	D	4.B	LO 5.6.A	5
10	B	1.A	LO 2.1.A	2
11	B	1.E	LO 4.9.B	4
12	C	4.D	LO 5.11.A	5
13	D	2.D	LO 5.11.A	5
14	C	1.B	LO 5.8.B	5
15	A	2.A	LO 2.3.A	2

Free-Response Question	Question Type	Skill	Learning Objectives	Unit
1	Concept Application	1.D, 1.E	LO 5.6.A, LO 5.7.A	5
2	Quantitative Analysis	3.A, 3.B, 3.C, 3.D	LO 1.7.A	1
3	SCOTUS Comparison	1.E, 2.A, 2.C	LO 1.7.A, LO 1.8.A	1
4	Argument Essay	5.A, 5.B, 5.C, 5.D	LO 1.1.A, LO 1.2.A, LO 1.3.A, LO 5.1.A, LO 5.3.B, LO 5.5.A, LO 5.8.B	1, 5

The scoring information for the questions within this course and exam description, along with further exam resources, can be found on the [AP U.S. Government and Politics Exam Page](#) on AP Central.



Scoring Guidelines

Question 1: Concept Application

The National Association of Home Builders, a national interest group that represents over 140,000 members in the home construction industry, has endorsed David Valadao (R) for reelection in California's Twenty-First Congressional District in the 2018 midterm election.

"Rep. Valadao has made housing and home ownership a top national priority and understands that expanding housing opportunities for all Americans is essential to the economic and social well-being of our nation," said Randy Noel, chairman of the National Association of Home Builders.

"We are proud to endorse Rep. Valadao for reelection in November because he helped to shepherd the landmark tax reform bill through Congress that will put more money into the pockets of hard-working families, reduce the tax burden for small businesses and promote job and economic growth," Noel said.

Recent polls show Valadao holding an 11-point lead over Democratic challenger T. J. Cox.

Source: "Valadao Picks Up Several Endorsements," *Hanford Sentinel* (Hanford, CA), October 19, 2018.

After reading the scenario, respond to A, B, and C below:

- (A) Describe an action being taken by the National Association of Home Builders in the scenario.
- (B) Explain how the action described in Part A affects policymaking in Congress.
- (C) Another group interested in conserving land in California supports the Democratic candidate in the election. Rather than having 140,000 members, the group is led by a few very wealthy families. Explain how this difference will likely affect the conservationist group's strategy in the election.

Scoring Guideline for Question 1: Concept Application

3 points

Learning Objectives: LO 5.6.A LO 5.7.A

- (A) Describe an action being taken by the National Association of Home Builders in the scenario. **1 point** 1.D

Acceptable description:

- By releasing a statement supporting Representative Valadao, the Home Builders Association is educating voters about the candidate in the upcoming election.

- (B) Explain how the action described in Part A affects policymaking in Congress. **1 point** 1.E

Acceptable explanations include:

- By publicly supporting candidates in elections, interest groups demonstrate to members of Congress their ability to affect elections, which could lead to members of Congress supporting the legislation promoted by the Home Builders Association.
- If interest groups publicly support candidates, members of Congress will likely recognize the political power of those interest groups when considering legislation that affects those groups. So, if members of Congress oppose this legislation, they run the risk of facing potential opposition from the Home Builders Association in the next election.

- (C) Explain how this difference will likely affect the conservationist group's strategy in the election. **1 point** 1.E

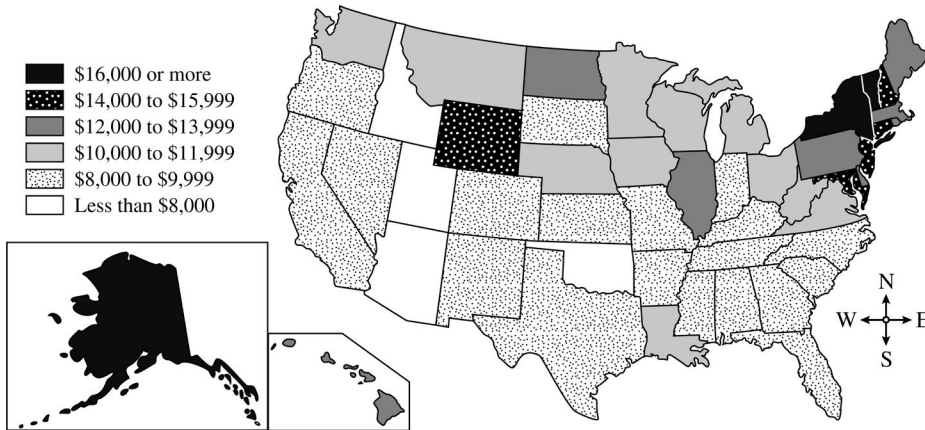
Acceptable explanations include:

- Groups with more members, such as the Home Builders Association, are generally more active in endorsing and publicly supporting candidates because they have strength in numbers with their memberships. A group that does not have many members but has funding, such as the conservationist group described in the scenario, will need to consider a different strategy, such as forming a political action committee or a super PAC.
- A conservationist group will probably use a different strategy because they have less members. Since they have money for funding they could collect large amounts of money to donate to the campaign.

Total for question 1 3 points

Question 2: Quantitative Analysis

PUBLIC EDUCATION SPENDING: AMOUNT SPENT PER PUPIL BY STATE IN 2014



Source: FairVote. www.census.gov

Use the information graphic to answer the questions.

- (A) Identify the most common level of education spending by states in the Southeast.
- (B) Describe a similarity or difference in public education spending by state or region, as illustrated in the information graphic.
- (C) Draw a conclusion about that similarity or difference in public education spending by state or region illustrated in the information graphic.
- (D) Explain how public education spending as shown in the information graphic demonstrates the principle of federalism.

Scoring Guideline for Question 2: Quantitative Analysis

4 points

Learning Objectives: LO 1.7.A

- (A) Identify the most common level of education spending by states in the Southeast. **1 point**
▪ \$8,000-\$9,999 **3.A**
-
- (B) Describe a similarity or difference in public education spending by state or region, as illustrated in the information graphic. **1 point**
Acceptable descriptions include:
▪ The Northeast region of the United States spends the highest amount of money on public education than any other region in the U.S.
▪ Southern states spend much less per student on public education than the Northeast states. **3.B**
-
- (C) Draw a conclusion about that similarity or difference in public education spending by state or region illustrated in the information graphic. **1 point**
Acceptable conclusions include:
▪ One possible conclusion is that Northern states are wealthier and thus can afford to spend more.
▪ Southern states may spend less because their priorities are not focused on public education while the Northeast values education more. **3.C**
-
- (D) Explain how public education spending as shown in the information graphic demonstrates the principle of federalism. **1 point**
Acceptable explanations include:
▪ While the national government requires states to provide education, states are permitted to create and organize their own education systems. Thus, as shown in the map all states spend money on education, but each spends a different amount per pupil. **3.D**

Total for question 2 4 points

Question 3: SCOTUS Comparison

This question requires you to compare a Supreme Court case you studied in class with one you have not studied in class. A summary of the Supreme Court case you did not study in class is presented below and provides all of the information you need to know about this case to answer the prompts

In 1935, Congress passed the National Labor Relations Act (NLRA), which among other things guaranteed workers the right to join a labor union and collectively bargain with employers. The law also established the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB), an independent agency responsible for enforcing the law.

The Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation fired ten workers attempting to unionize its plant located in Aliquippa, Pennsylvania. When the National Labor Relations Board determined this to be in violation of the recently passed NLRA, the company sued claiming that labor relations had only an indirect effect on commerce, and thus Congress did not have the constitutional power to regulate it.

In the subsequent case, *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation* (1937), the Supreme Court ruled in favor of the National Labor Relations Board by a 5–4 vote, holding that the Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation conducted interstate commerce and that industrial labor relations affects that commerce.

- (A) Identify the constitutional clause that is common in both *United States v. Lopez* (1995) and *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation* (1937).
- (B) Explain how the facts in *United States v. Lopez* led to a different holding than in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation*.
- (C) Explain how the holding in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones and Laughlin Steel Corporation* affected the balance of power between the states and the national government.

Scoring Guideline for Question 3: SCOTUS Comparison

4 points

Learning Objectives: LO 1.7.A LO 1.8.A

- (A) Identify the constitutional clause that is common in both *United States v. Lopez* (1995) and *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones* (1937). **1 point**
2.C
- The commerce clause.

- (B) Explain how the facts in *United States v. Lopez* led to a different holding than in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones*.

Acceptable explanations include:

One point for describing relevant information about the decision in the required Supreme Court case.

1 point

- In *United States v. Lopez*, the court ruled that gun possession was not an economic activity that that could be considered interstate commerce and, therefore, gun free schools zones could not be created or regulated by the national government.

2.A

OR

OR

Two points for correctly explaining how the facts in *United States v. Lopez* led to a different holding than in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones*.

2 points

- In *United States v. Lopez*, the court ruled that gun possession was not an economic activity that that could be considered interstate commerce and, therefore, gun free schools zones could not be created or regulated by the national government. In the *NLRB v. Jones* case, Congress determined that labor disputes were related to interstate commerce and that they did fall under the commerce clause and could be regulated by the national government.

OR

- (C) Explain how the holding in *National Labor Relations Board v. Jones* affected the balance of power between the states and the national government.

1 point

2.D

Acceptable explanations include the following:

- By granting Congress more authority to make laws under the commerce clause, and also to establish a regulatory agency to rule in labor disputes, it substantially increased the power of the federal government.
- The *NLRB v. Jones* case applied a very broad interpretation of what affects interstate commerce under the commerce clause. This increases the authority of Congress to make laws and establish agencies which increases the power of the federal government.

Total for question 3

4 points

Question 4: Argument Essay

Develop an argument that explains which of the three models of representative democracy—participatory, pluralist, or elite—best achieves the founders’ intent for American democracy in terms of ensuring a stable government run by the people.

Use at least one piece of evidence from one of the following foundational documents:

- Brutus 1
- Federalist No. 10
- U.S. Constitution

In your response, you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a defensible claim or thesis that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Support your claim with at least TWO pieces of specific and relevant evidence
 - ♦ One piece of evidence must come from one of the foundational documents listed above.
 - ♦ A second piece of evidence can come from any other foundational document not used as your first piece of evidence, or it may be from your knowledge of course concepts
- Use reasoning to explain why your evidence supports your claim or thesis.
- Respond to an opposing or alternate perspective using rebuttal or refutation.

Scoring Guideline for Question 4: Argument Essay

6 points

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A Claim/Thesis (0-1 points) 5.A	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Responds to the prompt with a defensible claim or thesis that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - The intended claim or thesis only restates the prompt. - The intended claim or thesis does not make a claim that responds to the prompt.	Responses that earn this point: The claim or thesis responds to the prompt rather than restating or rephrasing the prompt and establishes a line of reasoning.
	Examples that do not earn this point: Restates the prompt <i>"Three models of representative democracy—participatory, pluralist, and elite - are all ways of achieving a stable government"</i> Does not respond to the prompt <i>"The founders' intent for American democracy was to ensure a stable government as shown in the Constitution."</i>	Examples that earn this point: <i>"It is clear that the main intent of the founders best aligns with the model of elite representative democracy. The rules crafted for appointment of Congress members and the president demonstrate an elitist model of democracy for the nation"</i> <i>"The founders wanted the people to play a main role in the government and that is why the participatory model of representative democracy best describes the American political system"</i> <i>"The model that best describes the American political system is the pluralist theory of representative democracy where groups compete to make society better."</i>
	Additional Notes: - The claim or thesis must consist of one or more sentences that may be located anywhere in the response. - A claim or thesis that meets the criteria can be awarded the point whether or not the rest of the response successfully supports that line of reasoning.	

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria			
Row B Evidence (0-3 points) 5.B	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Provides one piece of evidence that is <u>relevant to the topic</u> of the prompt.	2 points Uses <u>one</u> piece of specific and relevant evidence to <u>support the claim or thesis</u> . OR Provides two pieces of evidence that are <u>relevant to the topic</u> of the prompt.	3 points Uses <u>two</u> pieces of specific and relevant evidence to <u>support the claim or thesis</u> .
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes			
	Responses that do not earn points: - Do not provide any accurate evidence - Provide evidence that is not relevant to the topic	Responses that earn 1 point: Must provide one piece of evidence relevant to the topic of the prompt This evidence can come from one of the foundational documents listed in the prompt, any other foundational document, or from knowledge of course concepts.	Responses that earn 2 points: - Must provide one piece of specific and relevant evidence that supports the claim or thesis. OR - Must provide two pieces of evidence relevant to the topic of the prompt. - This evidence can come from one of the foundational documents listed in the prompt, any other foundational document, or from knowledge of course concepts.	Responses that earn 3 points: Must provide two pieces of specific and relevant evidence that support the claim or thesis. One of these pieces of evidence must come from a foundational document listed in the prompt. The other piece of evidence can come from a different foundational document or from knowledge of course concepts.
	Examples that do not earn points: Not specific "The Federalist 10 defended the Constitution." Not relevant to course concepts in the prompt "The Constitution gives Congress the power to tax."	Examples of evidence that are relevant to the topic of the prompt: "The Constitution states the terms of offices and after those holding office must enter reelection" "Brutus I wanted the people to have the power warning that the Constitution would create a federal government that would possess absolute and uncontrollable power" Examples of acceptable specific and relevant evidence that support the argument (1 example is one piece of evidence): "The elitist model intentions of the founders are further seen in the Electoral College system. In this system, the people are allowed the initial vote for president, or the 'popular vote,' which determines the composition of the electorate" "The Constitution includes a Bill of Rights which includes the rights/liberties of the people. This gives people an incentive to be part of the governing process" "The Constitution also includes several amendments that give the people more of a say in government. For example, the 17th Amendment gives the people the power to vote for their senators allowing them to participate more in the government" "Federalist 10 shows that the founders wanted a pluralist democracy."		
	Additional Notes: - To earn one or two points in Row B, the response does not need to have earned the point for claim/thesis in Row A. - To earn three points in Row B, the response must have a defensible claim/thesis (earned the point in Row A) - To earn three points in Row B, the response must use one of the foundational documents listed in the prompt			

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row C Reasoning (0-1 points) 5.C	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses reasoning (classification, process, causation or comparison) to explain how or why the evidence supports an argument relevant to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Include evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument - Restate the prompt without explaining how the evidence supports an argument	Responses that earn this point: Must explain the relationship between the evidence provided and an argument
		Examples of reasoning that explain how evidence supports the claim or thesis: <i>"However the actual vote for president is left to a small number of individuals (electors) who cast the final ballots rather than just using the popular vote, mirroring the philosophies of the elite model"</i> <i>"All of these amendments to the Constitution allowed the people to participate more in government demonstrating that the founders wanted the public to be involved in their government"</i> <i>"This is a prime example of how pluralism is the best representation of American democracy because there are factions like political parties in the government, but they allow everyone's voice to be heard"</i>
Additional Notes: - To earn this point, the response must have provided at least one piece of specific and relevant evidence. - The explanation of the relationship between one piece of evidence and a well reasoned argument relevant to the prompt is sufficient to earn this point.		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row D Responds to Alternate Perspectives (0-1 points) 5.D	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Responds to an opposing or alternate perspective using rebuttal or refutation
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Restate the opposite of the claim or thesis - May identify or describe an alternate perspective but do not rebut or refute that perspective - Rebut or refute a foundational document rather than an alternate perspective	Responses that earn this point: Must describe an alternate perspective AND rebut or refute that perspective
	Examples of responses that do not earn the point: Restates the opposite of the claim or thesis <i>"Those who argue that the founders wanted an elite mode of democracy are incorrect because it is clear they wanted a participatory system"</i> Describes an alternate perspective but does not rebut or refute that perspective <i>"Although it is obvious that the elite model of democracy is what the founders intended, some argue that the founders actually wanted a participatory system of democracy in order to give the people authority over the government"</i>	Examples of acceptable responses to an alternate perspective may include: <i>"Advocates of the participatory theory may argue that citizens have the power to participate by voting in elections in the United States. However, the founders designed a government which allowed for representation of the people, while leaving the more complex and important decisions to a well-educated few, as demonstrated by the systems of elections for both senators and the president"</i> <i>"A counter argument is that the elite model is the best. This is supported by the United States Constitution, which gives the most power to property holding, wealthy, white males. This does not best reflect the founders' intent because the founders wanted the people, the citizens, in the United States to be in control. This is not possible with the elitist theory because only the wealthy have any say in the government under the elitist model, not all citizens"</i>
	Additional Notes: - To earn this point, the response must have a defensible claim or thesis (earned the point in Row A). - Responses that demonstrate an incorrect understanding of the alternate perspective do not earn this point.	